

American and British literature

Великолепное собрание американских и британских текстов, щедро приправленное загадками, шарадами и прочими интеллектуальными шалостями, *чтобы даже самая серьёзная олимпиадница могла почувствовать себя легко и остроумно*

ladada_eng x СТЁРТЫЕ КАЛАЧИ онлайн-школа

Стёртые калачи

проект для подготовки ко ВсОШ и перечневым олимпиадам по литературе, филологии и журналистике



Важное о нас:

- Наши курсы сделаны людьми с опытом составления и проверки Всероса.
- Мы изучаем историю и теорию литературы на вузовском уровне, практикуем олимпиадные форматы.
- Наши преподаватели — выпускники НИУ ВШЭ и МГУ. Работают в проектах ЦПМ и «Взлёт»

Ladada_eng

онлайн школа по подготовке к ЕГЭ по английскому для giiiirls only



Важное о нас:

- Наши ladadagirls поступают в вузы своей мечты, благодаря олимпиадам и высоким баллам за ЕГЭ. В 2025 году мы подготовили 27 призёров перечневых олимпиад. Maybe you are next?
- Никаких вебинаров, только индивидуальный подход к каждой.
- Поддержка, помощь с поступлением и первыми шагами в карьере.



ladada_eng x СТЁРТЫЕ КАЛАЧИ



Emily Dickinson (1830-1886)

- **Because I could not stop for Death (1890)**

One of Emily Dickinson's most celebrated poems. In the poem, a female speaker tells the story of how she was visited by "Death," personified as a "kindly" gentleman, and taken for a ride in his carriage. This ride appears to take the speaker past symbols of the different stages of life, before coming to a halt at what is most likely her own grave. Much of this poem's power comes from its refusal to offer easy answers to life's greatest mystery: what happens when people die.

- **I taste a liquor never brewed (1861)**

This poem is about getting completely drunk — not on booze, but on life. On a glorious summer day, the poem's speaker imagines drinking so deeply and joyously of nature's beauty that even the angels run to their windows to watch the speaker.

- **I'm Nobody! Who are you? (1891)**

In this poem, a speaker introduces themselves — perhaps to the reader — as "Nobody," before excitedly realizing that the addressee is "Nobody" too. Paradoxically, this hints at a community of "Nobodies" out there. These people just don't make as much noise as all the "Somebodies," who crave attention and admiration.

The poem, then, calls out to its readers to say that being humble, withdrawn, shy, or private is just fine. In fact, such a way of life has many virtues of its own. The poem is one of a number of Dickinson poems that questions the value of public admiration — something which eluded Dickinson in her own lifetime.



Langston Hughes (1902–1967)



- **The Negro Speaks of Rivers (1921)**

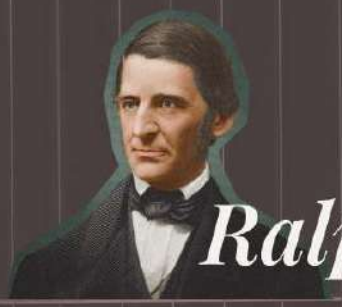
  Written when Hughes was just 17, this poem links the speaker's soul to the great rivers of the world — the Nile, the Congo, the Mississippi — suggesting a timeless, deep-rooted connection between African heritage and human civilization. It became an anthem of pride and endurance in Black identity.

- **Harlem (1951)**

  One of Hughes's most famous poems, often known by its opening line: "What happens to a dream deferred?" The poem reflects on the frustration of postponed aspirations, particularly within African American communities. Its explosive imagery of decay and violence captures the urgency of racial and social inequality.







Ralph Waldo Emerson (1803 - 1882)

- **Nature (1836)**

In this essay the author argues that stepping into nature is like walking into a living classroom and church combined. It provides everything we need to survive, it inspires us with its beauty, it gives us words and symbols to express our deepest ideas, and it teaches us moral lessons and discipline. Ultimately, Emerson tells us that to find ourselves and feel connected to the universe, we need to unplug from society's noise, spend time in nature with a sense of wonder, and learn to see the divine in every leaf and landscape.

- **Self-reliance (1841)**

Emerson starts his essay by arguing that our own original ideas are the most valuable things we have, even more than the ideas of famous people. He says we often dismiss our best thoughts simply because they're ours, but true maturity is learning to trust that personal genius.

He believes self-trust is the most important lesson a person can learn, and that we should actually imitate the self-reliance we see in babies, children, and boys — who naturally trust their own instincts, question authority, and aren't afraid to judge things for themselves.



William Faulkner (1897–1962)

- **The Sound and the Fury (1929)**

The Sound and the Fury by William Faulkner chronicles the tragic downfall of the Compson family in the American South, exploring themes of decadence, the burden of the past, time, and memory. Told through four distinct, often non-linear, stream-of-consciousness perspectives, the novel uses Benjy, Quentin, Jason, and Dilsey to reveal the family's disintegration and struggle with their fading aristocratic identity and changing post-Civil War society.

- **As I Lay Dying (1930)**

In William Faulkner's As I Lay Dying, the dysfunctional Bundren family embarks on a disastrous journey to bury their matriarch, Addie, in her chosen town of Jefferson. Each family member is driven by their own selfish motives: the father, Anse, wants new teeth; the pregnant daughter, Dewey Dell, seeks an abortion; and the son Cash is obsessed with his handmade coffin. Their trip is plagued by floods, fire, and the increasingly putrid smell of Addie's corpse. The intellectual son, Darl, goes insane and is eventually committed for burning a barn to end the farcical journey. After finally burying Addie, Anse immediately uses the trip to acquire new teeth and a new wife, revealing the family's deep selfishness and the journey's ultimate absurdity.

- **A Rose for Emily (1930)**

"A Rose for Emily" by William Faulkner tells the story of Emily Grierson, a reclusive Southern woman who lives in isolation following her father's death and engages in a scandalous relationship with a Northern man, Homer Barron. After his disappearance, the townspeople discover a horrifying secret in her home: Emily poisoned Homer and kept his body in a bridal suite, sleeping beside it for years, a macabre act resulting from her desperate attempt to overcome her loneliness and cling to the past. The story is a Southern gothic tale exploring themes of loneliness, isolation, the decline of the Old South, and the struggle between tradition and change, told through a non-linear narrative combining community memory and gossip.



Robert Frost (1874-1963)

- **Mending Wall (1914)**

This poem describes two neighbors who meet each spring to repair the stone wall between their properties. The speaker of the poem questions why the wall is necessary, since neither of them has livestock that needs to be contained. He playfully points out how nature itself seems to dislike the wall, as frost and hunters are always causing it to fall apart. However, his neighbor does not question the tradition. He simply repeats the old saying he learned from his father: "Good fences make good neighbors." The poem uses this annual activity as a metaphor to explore the human need for boundaries, the weight of tradition, and the sometimes unthinking ways we maintain barriers between each other.

- **The Road Not Taken (1916)**

This poem describes a person choosing between two paths in a yellow wood. The speaker admits both paths were worn "really about the same," but he picks one to travel another day, knowing he likely won't return. In the future, he plans to say he took the less-traveled path and that it "made all the difference." The theme is about how we look back on our lives. It explores our tendency to invent significance for our past choices, often pretending they were more unique or intentional than they really were.



- **Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening (1923)**

In Robert Frost's "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening," a traveler pauses his horse-drawn sleigh to watch the snow fall in a dark, peaceful forest. He is deeply drawn to the quiet beauty and feels a strong pull to stay. However, he remembers his responsibilities and decides he must continue his journey, emphasizing that he has a long way to go before he can rest. The poem captures the universal tension between our desire for peace or escape and our duty to honor life's obligations.



Scott Fitzgerald *(1896–1940)*

- **The Great Gatsby (1925)**

This is the tragic story of Jay Gatsby, a self-made millionaire who becomes obsessed with winning back his former love, the married Daisy Buchanan. Narrated by their neighbor Nick Carraway, the novel portrays the glamorous but morally empty world of the Jazz Age. Gatsby's extravagant wealth and idealistic dream are ultimately shattered by the harsh realities of social class, materialism, and the unattainable past, offering a critical look at the corruption of the American Dream.



- **Tender Is the Night (1934)**

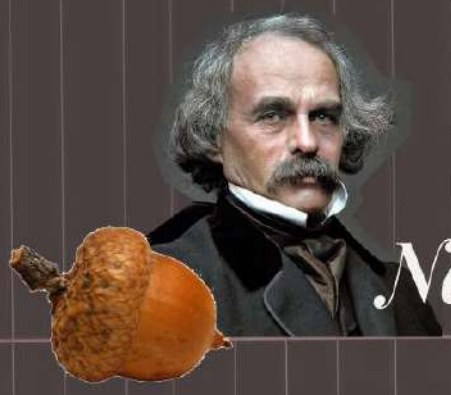
F. Scott Fitzgerald's Tender Is the Night tells the tragic story of Dick Diver, a promising American psychiatrist, and his wife, Nicole, who is also his patient. Their marriage begins as an act of devotion but slowly unravels due to the strains of her mental illness, his fading ambition, and the corrupting influence of the wealthy, idle American expatriate community in Europe between the World Wars.

Drawing from Fitzgerald's own life with his wife Zelda, the novel is a critique of the moral decay of the "lost generation" and a poignant exploration of how love and talent can be destroyed by obsession and the burdens of care.

- **The Curious Case of Benjamin Button (1922)**

This F. Scott Fitzgerald's short story follows a man who is born as an elderly infant and ages in reverse, growing younger as time passes. This fantastical premise is used to explore the profound impact of aging on human relationships, identity, and one's place in society. Benjamin's life is a poignant paradox: he is out of sync with everyone around him, experiencing life's stages — from marriage to fatherhood to childhood — in a reversed and often isolating order. The story is a thoughtful reflection on time, mortality, and the societal expectations that define a normal life.





Nathaniel Hawthorne (1804–1864)

- **Young Goodman Brown (1835)**

This short story follows a young Puritan man who takes a troubling walk in the forest one night. There, he sees a secret gathering that reveals the hidden sins of the most respected people in his town, including its religious leaders. This single night destroys his innocence and trust. He learns that everyone, even those who seem completely good, is capable of evil. The experience ruins his faith in his community and his religion, turning him into a bitter and distrustful man for the rest of his life. The story is a critical look at hypocrisy, the nature of good and evil, and the danger of judging others.

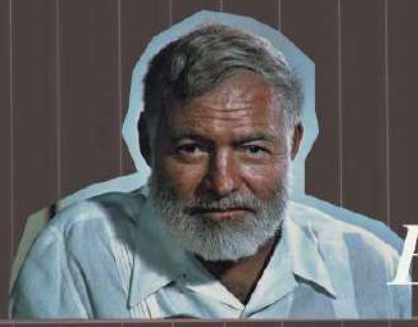
- **The Scarlet Letter (1850)**

Nathaniel Hawthorne's The Scarlet Letter is set in a strict 17th-century Puritan community. It tells the story of Hester Prynne, who is publicly shamed and forced to wear a scarlet "A" for adultery after giving birth to a child out of wedlock. Rather than fleeing, Hester remains in town, quietly rebuilding her life and raising her daughter, Pearl.

The novel explores the heavy impact of shame and secret guilt — not just on Hester, but also on the father of her child, a respected minister tormented by his hidden sin. Through Hester's strength and eventual redemption, the book critiques harsh social judgment and explores deeper themes of sin, punishment, and the possibility of personal grace in a rigid society







Ernest Hemingway (1899-1961)

- ## A Farewell to Arms (1929)

Ernest Hemingway's A Farewell to Arms tells the story of Frederic Henry, an American ambulance driver serving in the Italian army during World War I. He falls in love with Catherine Barkley, a British nurse, and their romance becomes a refuge from the chaos and violence of the war. After Frederic is wounded, they are separated by the fighting and eventually flee to neutral Switzerland to escape the conflict. There, they attempt to build a peaceful life together. However, their happiness is shattered when Catherine dies in childbirth, leaving Frederic utterly alone and disillusioned. The novel is a powerful story about the futility of war, the intensity of love, and the inevitability of loss, reflecting Hemingway's stark, realistic style.

- ## For Whom the Bell Tolls (1940)

This is a war novel set during the Spanish Civil War. It follows Robert Jordan, an American fighter, who is assigned to blow up a bridge behind enemy lines with the help of a band of local guerrillas. During the mission, he falls in love with a young woman named María and forms deep bonds with the group's members, especially the fierce leader Pilar. The story explores themes of sacrifice, bravery, and the personal cost of war. The title suggests that all people are connected: when one suffers, everyone is affected. It is considered one of Hemingway's greatest works.

- ## The Old Man and the Sea (1952)

Ernest Hemingway's The Old Man and the Sea tells the story of Santiago, an old Cuban fisherman who has gone 84 days without catching a fish. Determined to break his unlucky streak, he sails far out and hooks a giant marlin. After a long and exhausting struggle, he finally catches the fish and ties it to his boat.

However, on his way home, sharks are attracted to the blood and attack the marlin. By the time Santiago reaches shore, nothing is left but the skeleton. Despite losing his prize, the old man's struggle and refusal to give up earn him the respect of his village. The story is a powerful tale of perseverance, honor, and finding dignity in the effort itself, even when you return empty-handed.



Harper Lee (1926-2016)

To Kill a Mockingbird (1960)

Harper Lee's To Kill a Mockingbird is told through the eyes of Scout Finch, a young girl growing up in a small Southern town during the 1930s. The story focuses on her father, Atticus Finch, a lawyer who defends Tom Robinson, a Black man falsely accused of a crime. Despite facing hatred and prejudice from their community, Atticus stands for what is right, teaching his children about courage, empathy, and justice.

Through this experience, Scout and her brother Jem learn about the deep-seated racism in their society and the importance of standing up for what is fair, even when others do not. The novel is a powerful story about growing up, confronting injustice, and the moral strength required to fight against inequality.



Herman Melville (1819-1891)

- **Moby-Dick/The Whale (1851)**

A sea captain, driven by madness and a thirst for revenge, leads his crew on a dangerous voyage to hunt the giant white whale that once maimed him. Told through the eyes of a young sailor, the story explores the destructive power of obsession, the struggle between good and evil, and humanity's smallness against the vast, unforgiving force of nature. The whale itself becomes a powerful symbol of the unknowable and uncontrollable, whether it be fate, God, or the natural world.



- **Bartleby, the Scrivener (1853)**

A Wall Street lawyer hires a quiet, efficient copyist named Bartleby. At first, Bartleby works well, but soon he begins responding to all requests with a polite but firm refusal: "I would prefer not to." His passive resistance grows until he stops working entirely, yet refuses to leave the office. The lawyer, both puzzled and sympathetic, struggles to deal with Bartleby's strange behavior but finds himself unable to force or abandon him. The story raises questions about isolation, the meaning of work, and how far compassion should extend when faced with someone who rejects all help and expectation.

- **Billy Budd, Sailor (1924)**

In this tragic novella, a kind and innocent young sailor, Billy Budd, is forced to serve on a British warship. There, he attracts the hatred of the cruel master-at-arms, Claggart, who falsely accuses him of planning a mutiny. Overwhelmed by anger and unable to speak in his own defense due to a stutter, Billy strikes Claggart, accidentally killing him.

The ship's captain, Vere, sympathizes with Billy but believes military law leaves him no choice: he must sentence the young sailor to death. The story powerfully explores the clash between innocence and evil, individual morality and strict obedience to the law, leaving the reader to reflect on justice, compassion, and the cost of duty.



Edgar Allan Poe (1809-1849)

- **The Fall of the House of Usher (1839)**

A visitor arrives at the gloomy, crumbling mansion of his childhood friend, Roderick Usher, who suffers from a strange and extreme nervous illness. Roderick believes the house itself is alive and cursed, causing the decline of his family — including his twin sister Madeline, who is near death. After Madeline dies, Roderick entombs her in a vault within the house. But she is not truly dead — and returns, leading to a terrifying climax in which both twins die and the house itself splits apart and sinks into the dark lake. The story is a classic Gothic tale of madness, family curses, and the terrifying blur between the real and the supernatural.

- **The Tell-Tale Heart (1843)**

A man insists he is perfectly sane — yet he decides to kill an old man he lives with, not out of hatred or greed, but because he cannot stand the sight of the old man's pale, filmy eye. After carefully planning the murder, he suffocates the old man and hides the body under the floorboards. When the police arrive, the murderer acts calm and confident — until he begins to hear what he believes is the sound of the dead man's heart beating louder and louder under the floor. Overwhelmed by guilt and panic, he confesses to the crime, convinced the officers must hear it too. The story is a chilling exploration of madness, obsession, and the power of a guilty conscience.

- **The Tell-Tale Heart (1843)**

A man, grieving the loss of his beloved Lenore, is visited one night by a mysterious raven that can speak a single word: "Nevermore." Tormented by sorrow and loneliness, he asks the bird questions about whether he will ever see Lenore again or find peace — only to receive the same bleak reply each time. The raven's relentless refrain slowly drives the narrator deeper into despair, symbolizing how grief can become a permanent, haunting presence. The poem explores themes of loss, madness, and the inability to escape painful memories.



Jerome David Salinger (1919-2010)

- **A Perfect Day for Bananafish (1948)**

A troubled war veteran, Seymour Glass, is on vacation in Florida with his wife, Muriel, who is more concerned with fashion and gossip than her husband's fragile mental state. While she chats idly on the phone with her mother, Seymour goes to the beach, where he meets a young girl named Sybil and tells her a whimsical yet sad story about "bananafish" — creatures that gorge themselves until they can no longer escape their own greed.

His tender interaction with the child contrasts sharply with the shallow world of the adults around him. Shortly after returning to his hotel room — and finding Muriel still distracted and unaware — he takes his own life. The story quietly explores the deep isolation caused by trauma and the inability to connect in a materialistic world.

- **The Catcher in the Rye (1951)**

The Catcher in the Rye is about 16-year-old Holden Caulfield's journey through New York City after his expulsion from prep school, as he grapples with themes of alienation, the hypocrisy of adult society (which he calls "phony"), and a longing for authenticity and the preservation of childhood innocence. The novel is a coming-of-age story that explores Holden's internal struggles with depression, loneliness, and his search for meaning in a world he finds confusing and disappointing.



John Steinbeck (1902–1968)

- **Of Mice and Men (1937)**

Two migrant workers, George and Lennie, dream of owning their own farm during the Great Depression — a place where they can be free and independent. Lennie, a man with great physical strength but a child's mind, accidentally causes trouble wherever they go, and George must constantly protect him. When Lennie unintentionally kills a woman, George is faced with a terrible choice: let his friend be brutally killed by an angry mob or end Lennie's life himself to spare him further suffering. The story is a tragic exploration of friendship, shattered dreams, and the loneliness and cruelty faced by society's most vulnerable.

- **The Grapes of Wrath (1939)**

A family of farmers from Oklahoma is driven from their land during the Dust Bowl and economic collapse of the 1930s. They journey to California in search of work and a better life, only to face exploitation, poverty, and prejudice as migrant laborers. Through their struggles, the family and those they meet along the way learn about endurance, dignity, and the need for collective compassion in the face of systemic injustice. The novel is a powerful depiction of human resilience and a critique of social inequality, emphasizing that strength often lies in unity and shared struggle.

- **East of Eden (1952)**

A multi-generational saga set in California's Salinas Valley, this novel traces the destinies of two families — the Trasks and the Hamiltons — whose lives become deeply intertwined. At its heart is a powerful retelling of the biblical story of Cain and Abel, exploring the eternal struggle between good and evil, jealousy and love, rejection and redemption.

Through complex father-son and brother-brother relationships, the story examines whether humans are destined to repeat the sins of their ancestors or if they can choose their own path through free will and moral courage. It is a profound meditation on identity, forgiveness, and the search for meaning in a world shaped by both fate and choice.



Henry David Thoreau (1817–1862)

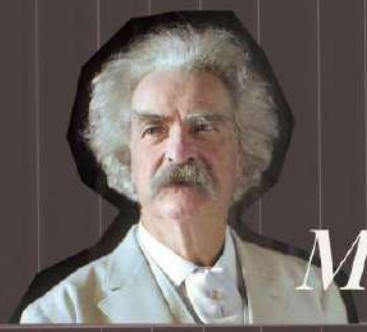
- **Civil Disobedience (1849)**

In this influential essay, the author argues that people have a moral responsibility to resist unjust laws and government actions. He believes that blindly following authority is less important than following one's own conscience. Inspired by his opposition to slavery and an ongoing war, he calls for peaceful, nonviolent resistance as a way to protest injustice and hold governments accountable. The text emphasizes the power of individual action in creating political change and has inspired many later movements for civil rights and freedom.

- **Walden/Life in the Woods (1854)**

A man builds a small cabin in the woods and lives there alone for two years, seeking a life of simplicity and purpose. He grows his own food, observes nature, and reflects on the value of time, freedom, and self-reliance. He criticizes modern society's obsession with wealth and busyness, arguing that true fulfillment comes from living deliberately, with few material needs and a deep connection to the natural world. The book is a quiet rebellion against complexity — a call to wake up and live authentically.





Mark Twain (1835-1910)



- **The Adventures of Tom Sawyer (1876)**

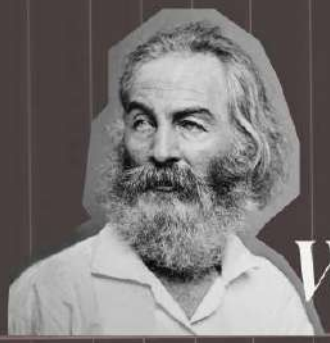
A mischievous but good-hearted boy, Tom Sawyer, grows up in a small town along the Mississippi River. He skips school, falls in love with Becky Thatcher, and embarks on adventures with his friend Huckleberry Finn — including hunting for treasure and testifying in a murder trial. Through his pranks and daring exploits, Tom navigates the freedoms and fears of childhood, learning about responsibility, friendship, and the complexities of right and wrong. The novel captures the spirit of youth, the thrill of adventure, and the nostalgia of a simpler time.

- **The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn (1885)**

A boy named Huck Finn fakes his own death to escape his violent father and sets off on a raft down the Mississippi River. He is joined by Jim, an enslaved man running toward freedom. As they travel together, Huck, raised in a racist society, struggles between the law that says Jim is property and his own growing friendship with him.

Through dangerous and often absurd encounters with thieves, feuding families, and con artists along the river, Huck learns to think for himself and ultimately decides to help Jim, even if it means going to hell. The novel is a powerful story about friendship, freedom, and choosing what's right over what's taught.





Walt Whitman (1819–1892)

- **Song of Myself (1855)**

A poem that celebrates the self, the body, and the soul not as something separate, but as part of everyone and everything. The speaker joyfully identifies with people from all walks of life: men and women, the free and the enslaved, city dwellers and farmers. He praises nature, work, desire, and the beauty of ordinary moments. Written in free verse without rhyme or regular meter, the poem rejects traditional poetic forms as it rejects narrow ways of thinking. It is an ode to democracy, equality, and the boundless energy of life itself.

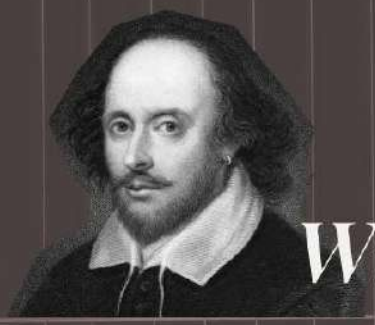
- **O Captain! My Captain! (1865)**

A ship returns safely to port after a long and fearful voyage, the battle is won, the people cheer. But the captain lies dead on the deck, cold and still. The speaker cries out in sorrow, torn between public victory and private grief: the nation has been saved, yet its leader (the "captain") will never celebrate the peace he made possible.

The poem captures both the relief at the end of the Civil War and the devastating personal and national cost of Abraham Lincoln's assassination. It is a lament for a fallen hero, admired and mourned by those he led to safety.



British authors



William Shakespeare (1564–1616)

- **Hamlet (1600–1601)**

  Perhaps the most famous tragedy in English literature. The Danish prince Hamlet seeks revenge for his father's murder, but his hesitation and philosophical doubts drive the play into a deep meditation on life, death, and morality. The iconic soliloquy "To be, or not to be" embodies the play's existential power.

- **Romeo and Juliet (1595–1597)**

  A tragic love story of two young people whose families' feud dooms their passion. The play explores the intensity of youthful love, the destructiveness of hatred, and the price of social conflict.



Geoffrey Chaucer (1343–1400)



- **The Canterbury Tales (1387–1400)**

A collection of stories told by pilgrims traveling to Canterbury. Each tale reflects a different perspective — comic, moral, romantic, bawdy — offering a vivid cross-section of medieval English society. The work's brilliance lies in its diversity of voices and in Chaucer's ironic, playful narrative style.







John Milton (1608–1674)

- **Paradise Lost (1667)**

An epic poem that retells the biblical story of the Fall of Man. With Satan as a strangely compelling figure, Milton investigates themes of free will, obedience, pride, and the human struggle between temptation and redemption. The poem's grandeur and theological ambition make it a cornerstone of English literature.







Jane Austen (1775–1817)

- **Pride and Prejudice (1813)**

  A witty and romantic novel that critiques class, marriage, and gender roles in Regency England. The sparring between Elizabeth Bennet and Mr. Darcy has become iconic, while Austen's sharp irony exposes the limitations placed on women of her time.

- **Sense and Sensibility (1811)**

  A tale of two sisters — one guided by reason, the other by emotion — navigating love, disappointment, and economic pressures. Austen contrasts rational restraint with passionate impulse, while still offering hope for balance and happiness.





Charles Dickens (1812–1870)

- **Great Expectations (1861)**

  The coming-of-age story of Pip, an orphan who dreams of becoming a gentleman. Themes of ambition, class, and moral growth drive the novel, which critiques Victorian society's obsession with wealth and status.



- **A Christmas Carol (1843)**

  A novella about Ebenezer Scrooge, a miser transformed by visits from three ghosts on Christmas Eve. Beyond its festive charm, the story is a moral lesson about compassion, generosity, and the possibility of redemption.

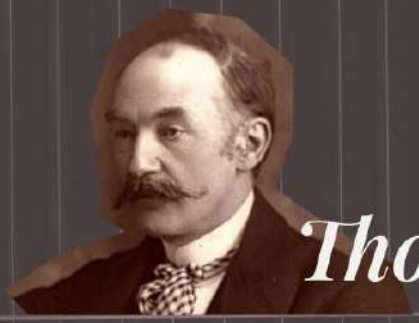
- **The Brontë Sisters (Charlotte 1816–1855, Emily 1818–1848, Anne 1820–1849), Jane Eyre (1847, Charlotte)**

  A gothic romance that follows an orphaned governess navigating love, independence, and morality. Jane's resilience and insistence on equality in love made the novel revolutionary for its time.

- **Wuthering Heights (1847, Emily)**

  A dark tale of passion and revenge set on the Yorkshire moors. The destructive love between Heathcliff and Catherine pushes beyond romance into obsession, cruelty, and the supernatural.





Thomas Hardy (1840–1928)

- **Tess of the d'Urbervilles (1891)**

  The tragic story of Tess, a young woman trapped by fate, social hypocrisy, and male power. Hardy critiques Victorian morality while exploring the cruelty of chance and the indifference of nature.

- **Far from the Madding Crowd (1874)**

  A pastoral novel centered on Bathsheba Everdene and her suitors. It combines rural life, romance, and questions of independence, desire, and social convention.



Virginia Woolf (1882–1941)

- **Mrs Dalloway (1925)**

  A modernist masterpiece told over a single day in London. Using stream-of-consciousness, Woolf reveals her characters' inner lives while exploring themes of memory, time, and trauma after World War I.

- **To the Lighthouse (1927)**

  A novel about family, art, and the passage of time, framed around a trip to a lighthouse. Woolf blends shifting perspectives and lyrical prose to question how meaning is created in human life.



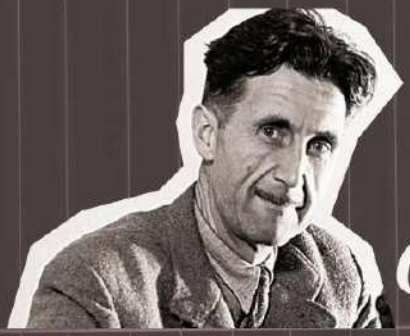
James Joyce (1882–1941)

- **Ulysses (1922)**

  A groundbreaking modernist novel that follows Leopold Bloom through Dublin in a single day. Modeled on Homer's Odyssey, it experiments with language, style, and form, making it one of the most influential (and challenging) works in English literature.

- **A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man (1916)**

  A semi-autobiographical novel tracing Stephen Dedalus's growth from childhood to self-conscious artist. It captures the struggle for identity, independence, and artistic freedom.



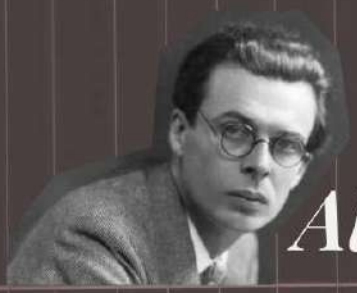
George Orwell (1903–1950)

- **1984 (1949)**

  A dystopian novel depicting a totalitarian regime where surveillance, propaganda, and language control crush individuality. Concepts like "Big Brother" and "doublethink" have become shorthand for authoritarian power.

- **Animal Farm (1945)**

  An allegorical novella in which farm animals overthrow their human master, only to see a new tyranny arise. A sharp satire of revolution, corruption, and political betrayal



Aldous Huxley (1894–1963)

- **Brave New World (1932)**

  A dystopian vision of a future society obsessed with technology, pleasure, and control. Citizens are engineered and conditioned for conformity, leaving little room for individuality or freedom. The novel critiques consumerism, dehumanization, and the loss of authentic experience.

- **Island (1962)**

  Huxley's utopian counterpart to Brave New World. Instead of warning about dystopia, it imagines a society built on mindfulness, balance, and enlightenment.





J.R.R. Tolkien (1892–1973)

- **The Lord of the Rings (1954–1955)**

  An epic fantasy trilogy chronicling the struggle against ***the Dark Lord Sauron***. Tolkien combines myth, language, and moral conflict to create a richly detailed world that set the standard for modern fantasy.

- **The Hobbit (1937)**

  A lighter prelude to ***The Lord of the Rings***. The story follows Bilbo Baggins, an unlikely hero on a journey filled with dragons, treasure, and self-discovery.



C.S. Lewis (1898–1963)

- **The Chronicles of Narnia (1950–1956)**

  A series of seven fantasy novels beginning with The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe. Combining Christian allegory with fairy-tale adventure, the books explore good versus evil, sacrifice, and redemption.

- **Mere Christianity (1952)**

  A work of theology adapted from wartime radio talks. Lewis lays out a rational case for Christian belief, blending philosophy, faith, and everyday language.



Salman Rushdie (1947)



- **Midnight's Children (1981)**

  A landmark novel blending magical realism with Indian history. Born at the exact moment of India's independence, the protagonist Saleem Sinai finds his life intertwined with the nation's destiny.

- **The Satanic Verses (1988)**

  A controversial and ambitious novel mixing myth, religion, and migration. Its exploration of faith, identity, and storytelling sparked intense debate and political backlash.





Zadie Smith (1975)

- **White Teeth (2000)**

  vibrant debut novel about multicultural London. Through two families, Smith explores race, immigration, generational conflict, and the clash between tradition and modernity—with humor and sharp observation.

- **On Beauty (2005)**

  A campus novel inspired by E.M. Forster's Howards End. It examines race, class, politics, and family dynamics in a transatlantic setting, balancing satire with empathy.





Practice makes perfect

ladada_eng x СТЁРТЫЕ КАЛАЧИ

Practice makes perfect

Task 1

1. Brave New World	A. Bram Stoker
2. Lord of Flies	B. Jonathan Swift
3. A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man	C. Jane Austen
4. Gulliver's Travels	D. Robert Louis Stevenson
5. A Clockwork Orange	E. Anthony Burgess
6. Dracula	F. John Bunyan
7. Persuasion	G. James Joyce
8. Kidnapped	H. Benjamin Disraeli
9. The Pilgrim's Progress	I. Aldous Huxley
10. Sybil	J. William Golding

To avoid a rigid mind

The writer George Orwell, in Animal Farm and 1984, warned of the dangers of totalitarian government, and we still describe that form of dictatorship as 'Orwellian'. Other examples of names becoming adjectives are ***Shakespearean, Victorian, Christian, Shavian (from Shaw) and Dickensian***. Do you know the adjectives from these names? (They don't all end in '-an'.)

Churchill, Machiavelli, Napoleon, Mao, Elizabeth, Stalin, Hitler, Confucius, Lenin, Kafka, Thatcher, Freud, Ritz, Marx, Plato.

Answers: Churchillian, Machiavellian, Napoleonic, Maoist, Elizabethan, Stalinist, Hitlerian, Confucian, Leninist, Kafkaesque, Thatcherite, Freudian, Ritzian, Marxist, Platonic.

Practice makes perfect

Task 2

1. Get busy living or get busy dying.	A. Lewis Carroll
2. History, Stephen said, is a nightmare from which I am trying to awake.	B. George Orwell
3. In a hole in the ground there lived a hobbit.	C. Oscar Wilde
4. Of course, it is happening inside your head, Harry, but why on earth should that mean that it is not real?	D. J. K. Rowling
5. For to have faith is to have wings.	E. Anthony Burgess
6. Anyone who ever gave you confidence, you owe them a lot.	F. Stephen King
7. It was a bright cold day in April, and the clocks were striking thirteen.	G. Bram Stoker
8. I can't go back to yesterday because I was a different person then.	H. James Joyce
9. There are darknesses in life and there are lights, and you are one of the lights, the light of all lights.	I. J. M. Barrie
10. Nowadays people know the price of everything and the value of nothing.	J. Truman Capote

Answers: 1 – F; 2 – H; 3 – E; 4 – D; 5 – I; 6 – J; 7 – B; 8 – A; 9 – G; 10 – C.

Practice makes perfect

Task 3

1. Pygmalion	A. Oscar Wilde
2. Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde	B. Sir Walter Scott
3. The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy	C. Charles Dickens
4. To the Lighthouse	D. William Shakespeare
5. The Taming of the Shrew	E. Agatha Christie
6. The Importance of Being Earnest	F. Robert Louis Stevenson
7. A Tale of Two Cities	G. H. G. Wells
8. Ivanhoe	H. George Bernard Shaw
9. And Then There Were None	I. Douglas Adams
10. The War of the Worlds	J. Virginia Woolf

Answers: 1 – F; 2 – H; 3 – E; 4 – D; 5 – I; 6 – J; 7 – B; 8 – A; 9 – G; 10 – C.

To avoid a rigid mind: *Fill in the blanks*

1. The phrase "Big Brother is watching you" comes from George _____.
2. Many everyday English expressions such as "break the ice" or "wild-goose chase" were first used by _____.
3. Edgar Allan Poe is often called the father of the _____ story.
4. Ernest Hemingway's minimalist style is known as the "_____ theory."

Answers: 1 – Orwell, 2 – Shakespeare, 3 – detective, 4 – iceberg.

Practice makes perfect

Task 4

1. The Great Gatsby	A. J. D. Salinger
2. The Grapes of Wrath	B. Herman Melville
3. The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn	C. Nathaniel Hawthorne
4. The Sound and the Fury	D. John Steinbeck
5. Moby-Dick	E. Toni Morrison
6. The Scarlet Letter	F. William Faulkner
7. Beloved	G. Mark Twain
8. The Old Man and the Sea	H. Edgar Allan Poe
9. The Catcher in the Rye	I. Ernest Hemingway
10. The Raven	J. Scott Fitzgerald

Answers: 1 – J; 2 – D; 3 – G; 4 – F; 5 – B; 6 – C; 7 – E; 8 – I; 9 – A; 10 – H.

To avoid a rigid mind: *Match the Author to the Place*

1. Shakespeare	a) Mississippi River
2. Jane Austen	b) Bath
3. Mark Twain	c) Stratford-upon-Avon
4. J.R.R. Tolkien	d) Oxford

Answers: 1 – c; 2 – b; 3 – a; 4 – d.

Practice makes perfect

Task 5

1. Charles Ryder	A. ***Three Men in a Boat,*** Jerome K. Jerome
2. Montmorency	B. ***Tinker, Tailor, Soldier, Spy,*** John Le Carré
3. Sherlock Holmes	C. ***Heart of Darkness***, Joseph Conrad
4. Holly Golightly	D. ***The Hound of the Baskervilles***, Sir Arthur Conan Doyle
5. George Smiley	E. ***The Old Man and the Sea,*** Ernest Hemingway
6. Yossarian	F. ***Under the Volcano,*** Malcolm Lowr
7. Kurtz	G. ***Brideshead Revisited,*** Evelyn Waugh
8. Santiago	H. ***The Sound and the Fury,*** William Faulkner
9. Geoffrey Firmin	I. ***Breakfast at Tiffany's,*** Truman Capote
10. Benjy	J. ***Catch-22,*** Joseph Heller

Answers: 1 – G; 2 – A; 3 – D; 4 – I; 5 – B; 6 – J; 7 – C; 8 – E; 9 – F; 10 – H

To avoid a rigid mind: *Match the Author to the word they are associated with*

Shakespeare	Big Brother
Lewis Carrol	yahoo
George Orwell	chortle
J.K. Rowling	muggle
Jonathan Swift	lonely

Answers: Shakespeare → lonely; Lewis Carroll → chortle; George Orwell → Big Brother; J.K. Rowling → muggle; Jonathan Swift → yahoo

Practice makes perfect

Task 6

A. A room with a View	E. Jane Eyre	I. Silas Marner
B. Clarissa	F. Jude the Obscure	J. The Man of Property
C. David Copperfield	G. mrs Dalloway	K. The Study in Scarlet
D. Heart of Darkness	H. Nineteen Eighty-four	L. Villette

1	Lucy Snowe, an Englishwoman, travels alone to teach at a girls' school in a fictional Belgian town. It's a psychological novel about isolation, repression, and unfulfilled love
2	A dystopian novel about Winston Smith, who struggles under the totalitarian rule of Big Brother. Themes include surveillance, propaganda, censorship, and the crushing of individuality.
3	A semi-autobiographical coming-of-age story following man's life from childhood hardships to adult struggles, through poverty, abuse, love, and career, ultimately finding success as a writer.
4	The first Sherlock Holmes story. Holmes and Watson investigate a murder in London, uncovering a tale of revenge that stretches back to the American West and Mormon communities.
5	Takes place in a single day in London. Clarissa Dalloway prepares for a party, while a parallel story follows Septimus Warren Smith, a shell-shocked war veteran. The novel explores time, memory, trauma, and identity.
6	Introduces the Forsyte family, wealthy and possessive. Focuses on Soames Forsyte and his troubled marriage to Irene, exploring themes of property, love, and personal freedom.
7	A working-class stonemason, dreams of studying at Oxford. His hopes are crushed by social constraints, failed relationships, and tragedy, painting a bleak picture of class and morality in Victorian England.
8	A weaver betrayed by his community lives in isolation, obsessed with hoarding gold. When his gold is stolen, he finds redemption through adopting a little girl, Eppie, which restores his faith in humanity.
9	A young Englishwoman, Lucy Honeychurch, travels to Italy where she meets George Emerson, who challenges her conservative upbringing. Torn between convention and passion, she must decide whether to follow societal expectations or her true feelings.
10	Marlow narrates his journey up the Congo River to find the mysterious ivory trader Kurtz. A haunting exploration of imperialism, human greed, and the darkness within the human soul.
11	One of the longest novels in English. It tells the tragic story of a virtuous young woman manipulated and ultimately destroyed by the libertine Lovelace. A tale of virtue, oppression, and morality.
12	An orphan girl becomes a governess at Thornfield Hall and falls in love with her employer, Mr. Rochester, who harbors a dark secret. It's a story of resilience, independence, love, and moral integrit

Answers: 1 – G; 2 – A; 3 – D; 4 – I; 5 – B; 6 – J; 7 – C; 8 – E; 9 – F; 10 – H

Practice makes perfect

Task 6

To avoid a rigid mind: *Some common English phrases use letters or numbers symbolically. Match them with their meanings.*

1. Catch-22	A no-win situation
2. Dot the i's and cross the t's	Pay attention to details
3. At sixes and sevens	Total confusion or disorder
4. Mind your P's and Q's	Be careful with manners/behavior
5. Alphabet soup	Overuse of abbreviations or acronyms

Answers: Catch-22 → A non-win situation; Dot the i's... → Pay attention to details; Sixes and sevens → Total confusion or disorder; Mind your P's... → Be careful with manners/behavior; Alphabet soup → Overuse of abbreviations or acronyms.

Practice makes perfect

Task 7

title	author	one-sentence summary
Gone with the Wind		
	Ray Bradbury	In a future where books are banned, a fireman begins questioning the system.
The Grapes of Wrath		
Lord of the Flies	William Golding	
The Color Purple		
	Margaret Atwood	In a dystopian theocracy, women are reduced to reproductive roles.
Catch-22		A WWII bombardier faces absurd military bureaucracy and the paradox of survival.
Brave New World		
	Richard Wright	A young Black man in 1930s Chicago becomes trapped by poverty, racism, and crime.
White Fang		

Practice makes perfect

Task 7: **Answers**

title	author	one-sentence summary
Gone with the Wind	Margaret Mitchell	A sweeping Civil War romance following Scarlett O'Hara's survival and ambition in the South
Fahrenheit 451	Ray Bradbury	In a future where books are banned, a fireman begins questioning the system.
The Grapes of Wrath	Ray Bradbury	A Dust Bowl family travels west seeking work, facing poverty and injustice.
Lord of the Flies	William Golding	Stranded boys descend into savagery on a deserted island.
The Color Purple	Alice Walker	Through letters, a poor Black woman narrates her struggle for dignity and love.
Fahrenheit 451	Margaret Atwood	In a dystopian theocracy, women are reduced to reproductive roles.
Catch-22	Joseph Heller	A WWII bombardier faces absurd military bureaucracy and the paradox of survival.
Brave New World	Aldous Huxley	A futuristic society achieves stability through genetic engineering, drugs, and conformity.
Native Son	Richard Wright	A young Black man in 1930s Chicago becomes trapped by poverty, racism, and crime.
White Fang	Jack London	A wild wolf-dog struggles for survival and adapts to human society.

Practice makes perfect

Task 8

1. Samuel Langhorne Clemens	A. Lemony Snicket
2. Joanne Rowling	B. Robert Galbraith
3. Stephen King	C. O. Henry
4. Daniel Handler	D. Boz
5. William Sydney Porter	E. Mark Twain
6. Charles Dickens	F. George Orwell
7. Mary Ann Evans	G. Richard Bachman
8. Eric Blair	H. Daniel Defoe
9. Daniel Foe	I. Irwin Shaw
10. Irwin Gilbert Shamforoff	J. George Eliot

Answers: 1 – E; 2 – B; 3 – G; 4 – A; 5 – C; 6 – D; 7 – J; 8 – F; 9 – H; 10 – I.

Practice makes perfect

Task 9

fictional character	book
1. Heathcliff	A. Pride and Prejudice
2. Clyde Griffiths	B. The Scarlet Letter
3. Clarissa Dalloway	C. Wuthering Heights
4. Dean Moriarty	D. On the Road
5. Elizabeth Bennet	E. An American Tragedy
6. Jay Gatsby	F. The Great Gatsby
7. Holden Caulfield	G. The Catcher in the Rye
8. Leopold Bloom	H. Ulysses
9. Jake Barnes	I. The Sun Also Rises
10. Atticus Finch	J. To Kill a Mockingbird
11. Mrs. Ramsay	K. To the Lighthouse
12. Pip	L. Great Expectations
13. Willie Stark	M. All the King's Men
14. Scarlett O'Hara	N. Gone with the Wind
15. Captain Ahab	O. Moby-Dick
16. Ebenezer Scrooge	P. A Christmas Carol
17. Quentin Compson	Q. The Sound and the Fury
18. Hester Prynne	R. Nine Stories
19. Seymour Glass	S. Nineteen Eighty-Four
20. Winston Smith	T. Nineteen Eighty-Four

Answers: 1 – C; 2 – E; 3 – R; 4 – D; 5 – A; 6 – F; 7 – G; 8 – H; 9 – I; 10 – J; 11 – K; 12 – L; 13 – M; 14 – N; 15 – O; 16 – P; 17 – Q; 18 – B; 19 – R; 20 – S.

Practice makes perfect

Task 10

1. Vanity Fair	5. As I Lay Dying	9. Alice's Adventures in Wonderland
2. The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn	6. The Red Badge of Courage	10. The Sun Also Rises
3. Kim	7. Sister Carrie	
4. The Scarlet Letter	8. Three Men in a Boat	

A	A rebellious boy and a runaway slave navigate the Mississippi River, exploring freedom, morality, and the absurdities of society.
B	A dark, symbolic tale of sin, guilt, and redemption in Puritan New England, centered on Hester Prynne.
C	A young soldier experiences fear, courage, and maturation during the Civil War, blending realism with psychological insight.
D	A post-WWI tale of expatriates in 1920s Europe, exploring love, courage, disillusionment, and the search for meaning.
E	Regency-era satire about social climbing, ambition, and vanity in early 19th-century England. A witty critique of human pretensions.
F	A Southern Gothic story following a family's journey to bury their matriarch, told through multiple perspectives with raw psychological depth.
G	An orphan boy in British India navigates espionage and adventure, exploring identity, loyalty, and cultural intersections.
H	A surreal, playful journey through a whimsical world, full of riddles, logic games, and unforgettable characters.
I	A humorous account of a boating holiday on the Thames, full of absurd mishaps, dry wit, and social satire.
J	The story of a young country girl pursuing the American dream in Chicago and New York, examining ambition, desire, and societal constraints.

Answers: 1 – E; 2 – A; 3 – G; 4 – B; 5 – F; 6 – C; 7 – J; 8 – I; 9 – H; 10 – D.

Practice makes perfect

Task 11

1. The Forsyte Saga _____
2. The Moon and Sixpence _____
3. A Study in Scarlet _____
4. East of Eden _____
5. A Tale of Two Cities _____
6. The Ambassadors _____
7. Vanity Fair _____
8. Rabbit, Run _____
9. Uncle Tom's Cabin _____
10. The Catcher in the Rye _____

Authors to choose from: Harriet Beecher Stowe, Charles Dickens, Arthur Conan Doyle, John Galsworth Tenry James, Somerset Maugham, J.D. Salinger, John Steinbeck, William Makepeace Thackeray, John Updike.

Answers: John Galsworthy, W. Somerset Maugham, Arthur Conan Doyle, John Steinbeck, Charles Dickens, Henry James, William Makepeace Thackeray, John Updike, Harriet Beecher Stowe, J.D. Salinger

Practice makes perfect

Task 12

1. The Scarlet Letter _____
2. Dracula _____
3. The Call of the Wild _____
4. The Woman in White _____
5. Death on the Nile, Rob Roy _____
6. The Light That Failed _____
7. Robinson Crusoe _____
8. The Prince and the Pauper _____
9. The Sound and the Fury _____

Authors to choose from: Agatha Christie, Wilkie Collins, Daniel Defoe, William Faulkner, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Rudyard Kipling, Jack London, Bram Stoker, Walter Scott, Mark Twain

Answers: Nathaniel Hawthorne, Bram Stoker, Jack London, Wilkie Collins, Agatha Christie, Walter Scott, Rudyard Kipling, Daniel Defoe, Mark Twain, William Faulkner

Practice makes perfect

Task 13

1. Dombey and Son _____
2. The Murder of Roger Ackroyd _____
3. A Connecticut Yankee in King Arthur's Court _____
4. Light in August _____
5. The Picture of Dorian Gray _____
6. Wuthering Heights _____
7. To Kill a Mockingbird _____
8. White Fang _____
9. The Sun Also Rises _____
10. Kim _____

Authors to choose from: Agatha Christie, Wilkie Collins, Daniel Defoe, William Faulkner, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Rudyard Kipling, Jack London, Bram Stoker, Walter Scott, Mark Twain

Answers: Charles Dickens, Agatha Christie, Mark Twain, William Faulkner, Oscar Wilde, Emily Brontë, Harper Lee, Jack London, Ernest Hemingway, Rudyard Kipling

Practice makes perfect

Task 14

1. Tender is the Night _____
2. A Farewell to Arms _____
3. Gulliver's Travels _____
4. Under the Net _____
5. Cakes and Ale _____
6. Brave New World _____
7. Persuasion _____
8. The Moonstone _____
9. Jane Eyre _____
10. The Remains of the Day _____

Authors to choose from: Jane Austen, Charlotte Brontë, Iris Murdoch, Wilkie Collins, Francis Scott Fitzgerald, Ernest Hemingway, Aldous Huxley, Kazuo Ishiguro, W. Somerset Maugham, Jonathan Swift.

Answers: F. Scott Fitzgerald, Ernest Hemingway, Jonathan Swift, Iris Murdoch, W. Somerset Maugham, Aldous Huxley, Jane Austen, Wilkie Collins, Charlotte Brontë, Kazuo Ishiguro

Practice makes perfect

Task 15

1. The History of Tom Jones, a Foundling _____
2. The Quiet American _____
3. Jude the Obscure _____
4. The Remains of the Day _____
5. All the King's Men _____
6. Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus _____
7. Lord of the Flies _____
8. Martin Eden _____
9. Our Mutual Friend _____
10. To the Lighthouse _____

Authors to choose from: Mary Shelley, Virginia Woolf, Charles Dickens, Henry Fielding, William Golding, Graham Greene, Thomas Hardy, Kazuo Ishiguro, Jack London, Robert Penn Warren.

Answers: Henry Fielding, Graham Greene, Thomas Hardy, Kazuo Ishiguro, Robert Penn Warren, Mary Shelley, William Golding, Jack London, Charles Dickens, Virginia Woolf

Practice makes perfect

Task 16

1. Far From the Madding Crowd _____
2. The Moon and Sixpence _____
3. The Golden Bowl _____
4. The Grapes of Wrath _____
5. Tender is the Night _____
6. Ulysses _____
7. Bleak House _____
8. The Man of Property _____
9. Middlemarch _____
10. The Way We Live Now _____

Authors to choose from: Charles Dickens, F. Scott Fitzgerald, John Galsworthy, Thomas Hardy, James Joyce, W. Somerset Maugham, George Eliot, John Steinbeck, Anthony Trollope, Henry James

Answers: Thomas Hardy, W. Somerset Maugham, Henry James, John Steinbeck, F. Scott Fitzgerald, James Joyce, Charles Dickens, John Galsworthy, George Eliot, Anthony Trollope

Practice makes perfect

Task 17

1. Vanity Fair _____
2. The Thirty-Nine Steps _____
3. An American Tragedy _____
4. The Public Image _____
5. The Wind in the Willows _____
6. Of Human Bondage _____
7. The Wings of the Dove _____
8. Wuthering Heights _____
9. Uncle Tom's Cabin _____
10. Cat's Cradle _____

Authors to choose from: Emily Brontë, Muriel Spark, Harriet Beecher Stowe, John Buchan, Theodore Dreiser, Kenneth Grahame, Henry James, W. Somerset Maugham, William Makepeace Thackeray, Kurt Vonnegut.

Answers: William Makepeace Thackeray, John Buchan, Theodore Dreiser, Evelyn Waugh, Kenneth Grahame, W. Somerset Maugham, Henry James, Emily Brontë, Harriet Beecher Stowe, Kurt Vonnegut.

To avoid a rigid mind: *Decide if these statements about English/American writers are true or false:*

1. Mark Twain's real name was Samuel Clemens.

2. Jane Austen published Pride and Prejudice under her real name.

3. Ernest Hemingway worked as a war correspondent.

4. Edgar Allan Poe is credited with writing one of the first detective stories.

5. F. Scott Fitzgerald was a close friend of William Shakespeare.

Answers: 1 – True, 2 – False (published anonymously), 3 – True, 4 – True (The Murders in the Rue Morgue), 5 – False (different centuries).

Practice makes perfect

Task 18

1. Lord of the Flies _____
2. To the Lighthouse _____
3. Beloved _____
4. The Light That Failed _____
5. The Sun Also Rises _____
6. The Invisible Man _____
7. The French Lieutenant's Woman _____
8. Wide Sargasso Sea _____
9. The Remains of the Day _____
10. The Scarlet Letter _____

Authors to choose from: Toni Morrison, Jean Rhys, Virginia Wolf, John Fowles, William Golding, Nathaniel Hawthorne, K guro. Rudvard Kipling. Ernest Heminewav, H.G. Wells

Answers: William Golding, Virginia Woolf, Toni Morrison, Rudyard Kipling, Ernest Hemingway, H. G. Wells, John Fowles, Jean Rhys, Kazuo Ishiguro, Nathaniel Hawthorne

To avoid a rigid mind:

1. Look at the word GHOTI carefully
2. Using your knowledge of English spelling, try to figure out how it might be pronounced.
3. Hint: Each part of the word borrows sounds from other English words.

Answer: Fish

gh → /f/ as in enough

o → /ɪ/ as in women

ti → /ʃ/ as in nation

Practice makes perfect

Task 18

1. Atonement _____
2. To the Lighthouse _____
3. Jude the Obscure _____
4. The Remains of the Day _____
5. The Painted Veil _____
6. The Ambassadors _____
7. The Scarlet Letter _____
8. Martin Eden _____
9. Lord of the Flies _____
10. Great Expectations _____

Authors to choose from: Virginia Woolf, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Kazuo Ishiguro, W. Somerset Maugham, Charles Dickens, Ian McEwan, Thomas Hardy, William Golding, Henry James, Jack London.

Answers: Ian McEwan, Virginia Woolf, Thomas Hardy, Kazuo Ishiguro, W. Somerset Maugham, Henry James, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Jack London, William Golding, Charles Dickens.

Practice makes perfect

Task 19

1. The Sign of the Four _____
2. Pride and Prejudice _____
3. Lucky Jim _____
4. Scoop _____
5. Under the Net _____
6. The Grapes of Wrath _____
7. Wuthering Heights _____
8. The Sound and the Fury _____
9. Kim _____
10. Slaughterhouse-Five _____

Authors to choose from: Jane Austen, Emily Brontë, Iris Murdoch, Arthur Conan Doyle, Evelyn Waugh, William Faulkner, Kurt Vonnegut, Rudyard Kipling, Kingsley Amis, John Steinbeck.

Answers: Arthur Conan Doyle, Jane Austen, Kingsley Amis, Evelyn Waugh, Iris Murdoch, John Steinbeck, Emily Brontë, William Faulkner, Rudyard Kipling, Kurt Vonnegut.

To avoid a rigid mind:

Some idiomatic phrases feature letters. What do the following mean?

Have you got an A to 2?

I'll have to watch my p's and o's.

She drops her h's.

We were taught the three R's.

Practice makes perfect

Task 20

1. Beloved _____
2. To the Lighthouse _____
3. All the King's Men _____
4. The Call of the Wild _____
5. Persuasion _____
6. Brideshead Revisited _____
7. The French Lieutenant's Woman _____
8. Wide Sargasso Sea _____
9. Tess of the d'Urbervilles _____
10. The Woman in White _____

Authors to choose from: Jane Austen, Toni Morrison, Virginia Woolf, Jean Rhys, Evelyn Waugh, Jack London, John Fowles, Wilkie Collins, Thomas Hardy, Robert Penn Warren.

Answers: Toni Morrison, Virginia Woolf, Robert Penn Warren, Jack London, Jane Austen, Evelyn Waugh, John Fowles, Jean Rhys, Thomas Hardy, Wilkie Collins.

Practice makes perfect

Task 21

1. The Remains of the Day _____
2. A Passage to India _____
3. The Golden Bowl _____
4. East of Eden _____
5. The Public Image _____
6. A Farewell to Arms _____
7. Brave New World _____
8. Gulliver's Travels _____
9. The Heart of the Matter _____
10. The War of the Worlds _____

Authors to choose from: H. G. Wells, Kazuo Ishiguro, Jonathan Swift, Aldous Huxley, Ernest Hemingway, Graham Greene, John Steinbeck, E. M. Forster, Henry James, Evelyn Waugh.

Answers: Kazuo Ishiguro, E. M. Forster, Henry James, John Steinbeck, Evelyn Waugh, Ernest Hemingway, Aldous Huxley, Jonathan Swift, Graham Greene, H. G. Wells.

Practice makes perfect

Task 22

1. A Tale of Two Cities _____
2. White Fang _____
3. The Moonstone _____
4. Wuthering Heights _____
5. Pride and Prejudice _____
6. Ulysses _____
7. The Sign of the Four _____
8. Gulliver's Travels _____
9. Middlemarch _____
10. Rebecca _____

Authors to choose from: Emily Brontë, Jonathan Swift, James Joyce, Wilkie Collins, Daphne du Maurier, Jack London, Charles Dickens, George Eliot, Arthur Conan Doyle, Jane Austen.

Answers: Charles Dickens, Jack London, Wilkie Collins, Emily Brontë, Jane Austen, James Joyce, Arthur Conan Doyle, Jonathan Swift, George Eliot, Daphne du Maurier.

Practice makes perfect

Task 23

1. Edgar Allan Poe	5. Oscar Wilde	9. J.K. Rowling
2. Lewis Carroll	6. J.R.R. Tolkien	
3. Mark Twain	7. Charles Dickens	
4. George Orwell	8. Agatha Christie	

A	Were you so poor that during the writing of your first book you manually typed out each copy, sending them to publishers, all of whom rejected it, until a small publisher finally accepted it?
B	Did you study poisons extensively, using your knowledge later to create murder plots in your novels?
C	Were you so obsessed with logic and puzzles that you photographed children of your friends to create intricate games and stories?
D	Did you invent mechanical devices like a mnemonic system and an electric pen while also writing novels?
E	Were you one of the first writers to describe forensic investigation techniques in a detective story?
F	Were you so financially inventive that you created gadgets and clever devices like self-pasting scrapbook, adjustable and detachable garment strap to solve everyday problems?
G	Did you design a room entirely covered with mirrors to observe yourself from every angle?
H	Did you immerse yourself among the poor and marginalized to accurately depict society in your novels?
I	Did you invent whole languages and alphabets for your novels, complete with grammar and vocabulary?

1. Did you immerse yourself among the poor and marginalized to accurately depict society in your novels? (George Orwell)
2. Did you invent whole languages and alphabets for your novels, complete with grammar and vocabulary? (J.R.R. Tolkien)

Answers: 1 – E; 2 – C; 3 – F; 4 – H; 5 – G; 6 – I; 7 – D; 8 – B; 9 – A.

Practice makes perfect

Task 24

1. Jane Austen	5. Cormac McCarthy
2. Lord Byron	6. Ernest Hemingway
3. Percy Shelley	7. J.R.R. Tolkien
4. George Eliot	

A	Wrote 500 words a day, mostly in the morning to avoid the midday heat. Productivity was key!
B	Was persuaded to start a vegan diet after reading John Frank Newton. He even wrote brochures promoting vegetarianism.
C	Loved animals! His estate in Venice was home to 10 horses, 3 monkeys, 3 peacocks, 5 cats, 8 dogs, a crane, a falcon, a crow, and an eagle.
D	Spent two years researching words beginning with "W"! Among his creations are "waggle" and "walrus," proving he took etymology very seriously.
E	Also known as Mary Ann Evans! She used a pen name because female writers were not taken as seriously as men during the Victorian era. Her novels are celebrated for their realism and psychological depth.
F	Don't throw away what isn't broken! In 2009, his beloved typewriter sold for $250,000 at auction.
G	Cared deeply about her characters, imagining their futures even after finishing her novels. Her nephew Edward Austen-Leigh wrote: "She would tell us many little particulars about the subsequent career of some of her people.

Answers: 1 – G; 2 – C; 3 – B; 4 – E; 5 – F; 6 – A; 7 – D.

To avoid a rigid mind: *Fill in the blanks*

1. The phrase "Big Brother is watching you" comes from George _____.
2. Many everyday English expressions such as "break the ice" or "wild-goose chase" were first used by _____.
3. Edgar Allan Poe is often called the father of the _____ story.
4. Ernest Hemingway's minimalist style is known as the "_____ theory."

Answers: 1 – Orwell, 2 – Shakespeare, 3 – detective, 4 – iceberg.

Practice makes perfect

Task 25

To avoid a rigid mind: *Some common English phrases use letters or numbers symbolically. Match them with their meanings.*

1. Catch-22	A no-win situation or a logical paradox
2. Dot the i's and cross the t's	To be meticulous and precise, to finish the final details
3. At sixes and sevens	In a state of confusion, disarray, or disagreement
4. Mind your P's and Q's	To be on your best behavior; to be careful of your words and actions
5. Alphabet soup	A confusing or confusing mixture of things, especially acronyms or abbreviations

Answers: Catch-22 → A non-win situation; Dot the i's... → Pay attention to details; Sixes and sevens → Total confusion or disorder; Mind your P's... → Be careful with manners/behavior; Alphabet soup → Overuse of abbreviations or acronyms.

To avoid a rigid mind: *Decide if these statements about English/American writers are true or false:*

1. Mark Twain's real name was Samuel Clemens
2. Jane Austen published Pride and Prejudice under her real name.
3. Ernest Hemingway worked as a war correspondent.
4. Edgar Allan Poe is credited with writing one of the first detective stories.
5. F. Scott Fitzgerald was a close friend of William Shakespeare.

Answers: 1 – True, 2 – False (it was published "By the Author of Sense and Sensibility"), 3 – True, 4 – True (The Murders in the Rue Morgue), 5 – False (they lived centuries apart).

Practice makes perfect

Task 25 2/2

To avoid a rigid mind: *Match the Author to the Place*

1. Shakespeare	a) Mississippi River
2. Jane Austen	b) Bath
3. Mark Twain	c) Stratford-upon-Avon
4. J.R.R. Tolkien	d) Oxford

Answers: 1 – c (his birthplace and where he retired); 2 – b (a city she lived in and used as a setting in her novels); 3 – a (central to his most famous works, like Adventures of Huckleberry Finn); 4 – d (where he was a professor).